Master Prompt — RepoSkins Free Kit

Cards · Snake Trail · social badges. One prompt, three phases.

> **Read this first.**
> This prompt drives a coding assistant through the RepoSkins Master Kit — a template engine, not a generative one. Two people running this against the same GitHub username get the exact same cards, pixel for pixel, because the kit renders real templates against real data rather than inventing anything. What varies is your data: your name, your avatar, your contribution graph, your stars. The value of the prompt is in the checkpoints — creating the profile repo the wrong way is a silent failure that doesn't show up until later, and it's the one step in this whole process that isn't just copy-paste.

> **You need:**
> a coding assistant with shell access (or just a terminal), Python 3.10+, the `gh` CLI, and a GitHub account. Budget 10 minutes.

▼ THE PROMPT — copy everything below to "END OF PROMPT" ▼

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I want to set up my animated GitHub profile using the RepoSkins Master
Kit (github.com/leonardoborgesdev/reposkins). Walk me through it step
by step, and check in with me after each phase before moving on.

My details
- GitHub username: [USERNAME] (profile repo will be
  [USERNAME]/[USERNAME], branch main)
- Theme: midnight or github-dark - I choose: [THEME]
- Cards I want: [e.g. hero,wordmark,heatmap,portrait,chess,
  system-scan,highlights,social-row,snake-trail]
- My social links for badges (optional): [e.g. linkedin:https://...,
  instagram:https://..., email:me@example.com]

PHASE 1 - Authenticate and generate
Run "gh auth status". If I'm not logged in, walk me through
"gh auth login". Then export the token:
"export GITHUB_TOKEN=$(gh auth token)". Without this the heatmap and
Snake Trail cards come back with an empty contribution graph and
I'll hit the public API's 60 req/hour limit fast.

Then run "python generate.py [USERNAME] --theme [THEME] --cards
[CARDS] --badges "[BADGES]"". If snake-trail is in my list and my
theme isn't midnight, tell me it rendered in midnight colors anyway
- that's expected, flag it, don't let it pass silently. Show me the
generated SVGs - open them, don't just tell me it worked - before we
go further.

PHASE 2 - The special repo
Remind me the repo must be named exactly [USERNAME]/[USERNAME] and
created through GitHub's web UI, not the API, with "Add a README
file" checked. A repo created via API sometimes fails to trigger the
special profile display. This is the step people skip and then ask
why nothing shows up.

PHASE 3 - Publish
Help me copy assets/ into the repo root, copy
README.generated.md into README.md, commit, push. That's it - every
card is a static file, nothing to schedule and nothing left running
anywhere after this push.

How to work with me
- Verify by opening the file, not by trusting the command's exit
  code. A 0 exit code means the script ran, not that the SVG looks
  right.
- When I say something "didn't change," check the raw file first
  with a cache-busting ?v=999 query string before touching any code.
  It's almost always GitHub's cache, not a bug.
- Tell me when I'm wrong. If a step won't work the way I described
  it, say so instead of trying it anyway.
- If I reject something twice, stop and ask rather than trying a
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```
  third variation.

END OF PROMPT
```

What to expect

Phase	Effort	Iteration?
1 — Authenticate + generate	5 min	Maybe — re-run with different cards or theme
2 — Special repo	2 min	No, but easy to get wrong once
3 — Publish	2 min	No

The whole thing is copy-paste and could be done without any assistant at all — the prompt exists so you get one continuous session instead of switching between a document and a terminal.

Known issues

Issue	Status
`about` , `stats` , `stack` cards only theme correctly in `midnight`	Excluded from the free kit rather than shipped half-themed
Wordmark's `P` , `Q` , `W` , `X` are hand-drawn, not extracted from a real capture (no source name had them)	Same stroke style as the other 22 real letters; flagged here for transparency, not hidden
Snake Trail only has a real template in `midnight`	Shipped as a labeled bonus card rather than excluded — the fallback is visible, not silent

Approaches that were tried and dropped

- **A generic GitHub Actions contribution snake, using Platane/snk.** It worked and looked fine in isolation, but next to every other card — which all share one card shell, one glow treatment, one visual language — it stood out as a plain grid with no branding. Replaced with Snake Trail, built from the same real-template technique as every other card, shipped as a static file instead of a workflow.
- **A clean gh-pages-style deploy action for publishing that snake.** Before it was dropped entirely, the snake workflow briefly used an action that force-replaces the entire target branch on every run. On a profile that already published something else to that same branch (a generated GIF, in one real case), this would have silently deleted it on the very first run — caught before shipping, not after.
- **Guessing the live product's API URL pattern to auto-extract more theme templates.** Every guessed path either 404'd or returned the site's JS app shell instead of an SVG. Reliable template extraction requires actually driving a browser against the real UI and capturing the rendered request — there's no shortcut through URL pattern-matching.
- **Hosting the generator behind one shared backend.** Works, but ties every user's rate limit and uptime to the same server and the same GitHub token. The whole point of this kit is the opposite: your token, your machine, your repo.

> **The core tradeoff.**
> Pixel-perfect fidelity to a theme requires a real template, hand-extracted from the live product by actually using its UI once. That work doesn't scale by writing more code — it scales by spending more hands-on time per theme. That's the honest reason this kit ships exactly 2 themes instead of all 21: those are the two someone actually sat down and extracted properly. Everything else in the kit (the data fetching, the card layout logic, the Snake Trail card, the badges) is free to extend yourself — the repo is MIT licensed.

If you only want badges — skip most of this document. Phase 3 needs no card generation at all; `badges.py` in the repo works standalone.

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